

Authorization holds, release and reversal

Purpose and responsibility

Use for cancelled purchases, remaining holds or uncertain reversal status. Reversal releases unconsumed authorization; refund addresses confirmed capture. Neither an intent cancellation nor an elapsed expiry expectation proves release.

The Gateway Owner confirms hold/reversal records; the Capture Owner establishes consumed units. Payment Operations separates the two before advising a next step. No release, refund or customer account update is executed by this guide.

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Scope	authorization, release, capture
Risks / sources	R04, R08, R09, R19 / E02, E03, E04, E05, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Determine what remains authorized

Read-only checks

Obtain E02 cancellation/submission history, E03 authorization confirmation and E04 distinct capture acknowledgements. Calculate confirmed consumption in SYN_UNIT. List unresolved capture operations separately; they reserve headroom and may prevent a reliable conclusion about the remaining releasable amount.

Request E05 for the exact authorization and any reversal request. Compare active, release-pending, released and explicitly expired records using their source versions. Source collection time or a local cancelled flag is not confirmation. Use E10's effective expiry rule and E11 clock uncertainty when comparing timing. If these are missing, retain the expiry question as unresolved.

Branches and negative checks

Established fact	Direction and limitation
No capture and active confirmed hold	Ask Gateway Owner to review separately authorized release eligibility
Confirmed capture consumes authorization	Release cannot return captured units; investigate refund separately
Reversal requested without final result	Keep release outcome unknown; request E05 acknowledgement
Explicit release/expiry but stale display	Compare projection freshness; do not infer a second live hold

Check whether two visible entries refer to one authorization, different attempts or repeated events. A complete empty release query must use the right authorization and retained window. Missing release evidence is not proof of a failed reversal. If capture and release confirmations appear inconsistent, preserve both and their versions rather than treating the newest display as the true state.

Human review and validation

Conditional recovery

Any release recommendation requires confirmed unconsumed amount, known original outcome, applicable policy and a separate human authorization. Pending capture exposure or source conflict blocks that conclusion. A refund against a confirmed capture has its own operation identity and is reviewed using RB-106, not relabeled as reversal.

For a stale display, the owner may inspect projection lineage and notification history without changing the authoritative hold record. Validation after an authorized projection correction compares the same E05 authorization/version with the displayed state. Clearing a display does not prove downstream release.

Escalation record

Retain authorization identity, confirmed/pending capture totals, effective expiry rule, release attempt/result, clock uncertainty and source coverage. Request the specific missing confirmation from the Gateway Owner. An unresolved cancellation must state what remains unknown and the next evidence checkpoint.

Rollback of a local change does not recreate or undo a downstream hold; record that boundary in any separately authorized action plan. Current MCP exposes no item-level hold/reversal source. E02-E11 are future requirements, and degraded/ empty reports must retain Q6 LOW/null cause and recommendation.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: RB-102, RB-106, PL-102, PL-103.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.